

Lab - Using Access Keys with Azure Storage Explorer To Begin with the Lab

Summary

This lab demonstrates how to connect **Azure Storage Explorer** to an Azure Storage Account using **Access Keys**. By using the storage account name and access key, you can browse and manage blobs, files, queues, and tables without using Azure AD authentication.

Understanding

Azure Storage Explorer is a desktop application used to manage Azure Storage resources. It allows you to connect to a Storage Account using an **Access Key**, a **Connection String**, **SAS Token**, or **Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD)**.

When you use an **Access Key**, Storage Explorer authenticates directly with the Storage Account, giving you full access to all storage services. This method is useful for administrators, testing, and scenarios where Azure AD authentication is not available.

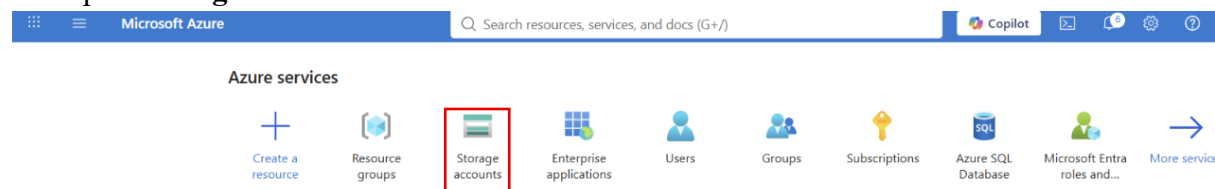
Example:

Suppose you have a Storage Account named **cloudxuesstorage**. You copy the account name and one of its access keys from the Azure Portal. In Azure Storage Explorer, you select **Use a storage account name and key**, enter the details, and successfully connect. You can then upload, download, create, or delete blobs from the storage account.

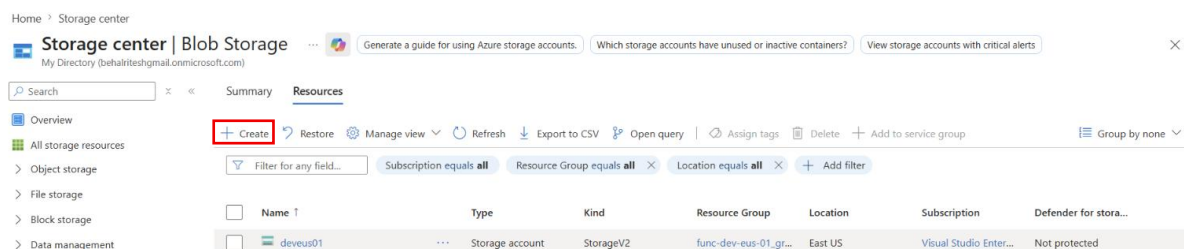
Lab Steps

Step 1: Create a Storage Account

- Go to the Azure Portal.
- Open **Storage Accounts**.



- Click **Create**.



- Select the Subscription and **Resource Group**.
- Enter a **unique Storage Account name**.
- Choose the **Region** and Performance.
- Click **Review + Create**.
- Click **Create**.

Create a storage account ...

[Learn more about Azure storage accounts](#)

Project details

Select the subscription in which to create the new storage account. Choose a new or existing resource group to organize and manage your storage account together with other resources.

Subscription * Visual Studio Enterprise Subscription ▼

Resource group * Webapp ▼

[Create new](#)

Instance details

Storage account name * ⓘ stdeveus200

Region * ⓘ (US) East US ▼

[Deploy to an Azure Extended Zone](#)

Primary service * Azure Blob Storage or Azure Data Lake Storage ▼

ℹ This helps us provide relevant guidance. It doesn't restrict your storage to this resource type. [Learn more](#)

Performance * ⓘ

☒ **Standard:** Recommended for most scenarios (general-purpose v2 account)

☐ **Premium:** Recommended for scenarios that require low latency.

Redundancy * ⓘ Locally redundant storage (LRS) ▼

Previous Next Review + create

Step 2: Retrieve the Access Key

- Open the Storage Account.
- Navigate to **Security + networking**.
- Click **Access keys**.
- Copy the **Storage Account Name**.
- Copy **Key1** or **Key2**.

Home > stdeveus200_1784891313648 | Overview > stdeveus200

stdeveus200 | Access keys ☆ ...

Storage account

Search

Overview
Activity log
Tags
Diagnose and solve problems
Access Control (IAM)
Data migration
Events
Storage browser
Storage Mover
Partner solutions
Resource visualizer
Data storage
Security + networking
Networking
Front Door and CDN
Access keys
Shared access signature
Encryption

Set rotation reminder Refresh Give feedback

Access keys authenticate your applications' requests to this storage account. Keep your keys in a secure location like Azure Key Vault, and replace them often with new keys. The two keys allow you to replace one while still using the other.

Remember to update the keys with any Azure resources and apps that use this storage account.
[Learn more about managing storage account access keys](#)

Storage account name
stdeveus200

key1 Rotate key
Last rotated: 7/24/2026 (0 days ago)
Key
..... Show
Connection string
..... Show

key2 Rotate key
Last rotated: 7/24/2026 (0 days ago)
Key
..... Show
Connection string
..... Show

Step 3: Add Container

- Go to the **Data Storage**.
- Navigate to **Container**.
- Click on the **Add container**.
- Enter the **container Name (data)**.
- Click on the **Create**.

Home > stdeveus200_1784891313648 | Overview > stdeveus200

stdeveus200 | Containers ☆ ...

Storage account

Search

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Data storage
Containers
Classic file shares
Queues
Tables
Security + networking
Networking
Front Door and CDN

+ Add container Upload Refresh Delete Change access level Restore containers Edit columns

Search containers by prefix

Showing all 1 items

☐	Name	Last modified	Anonymous access level
☐	data	7/24/2026, 4:40:02 PM	Private

New container ✕

Name *
data

Anonymous access level
Private (no anonymous access)

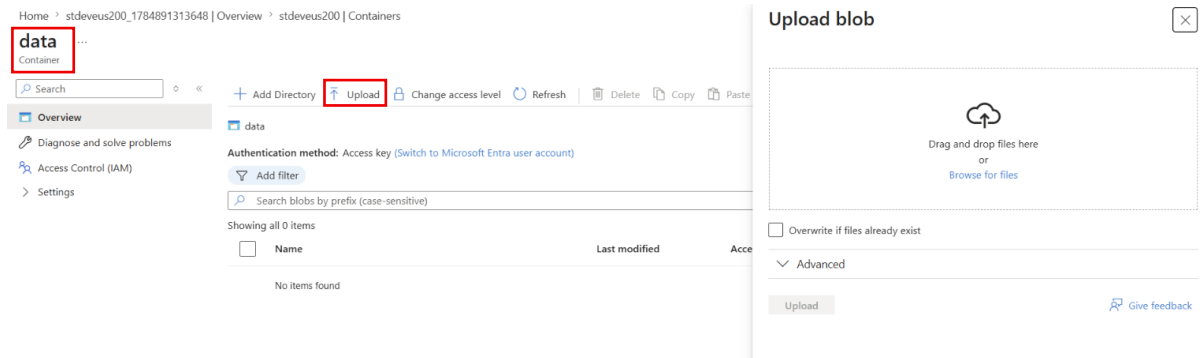
The access level is set to private because anonymous access is disabled on this storage account.

Advanced

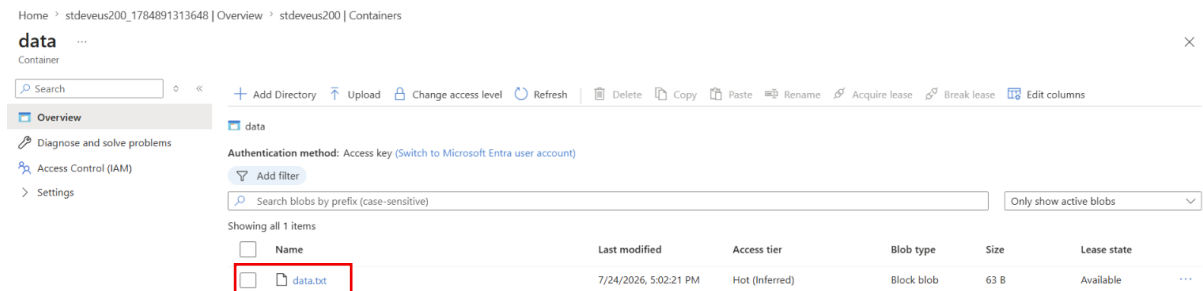
Create Give feedback

Step 4: upload file in Container

- Open the just add **data container**.
- Click on the **Upload**.
- Click on the **Browse for Files**



• Uploaded any File.

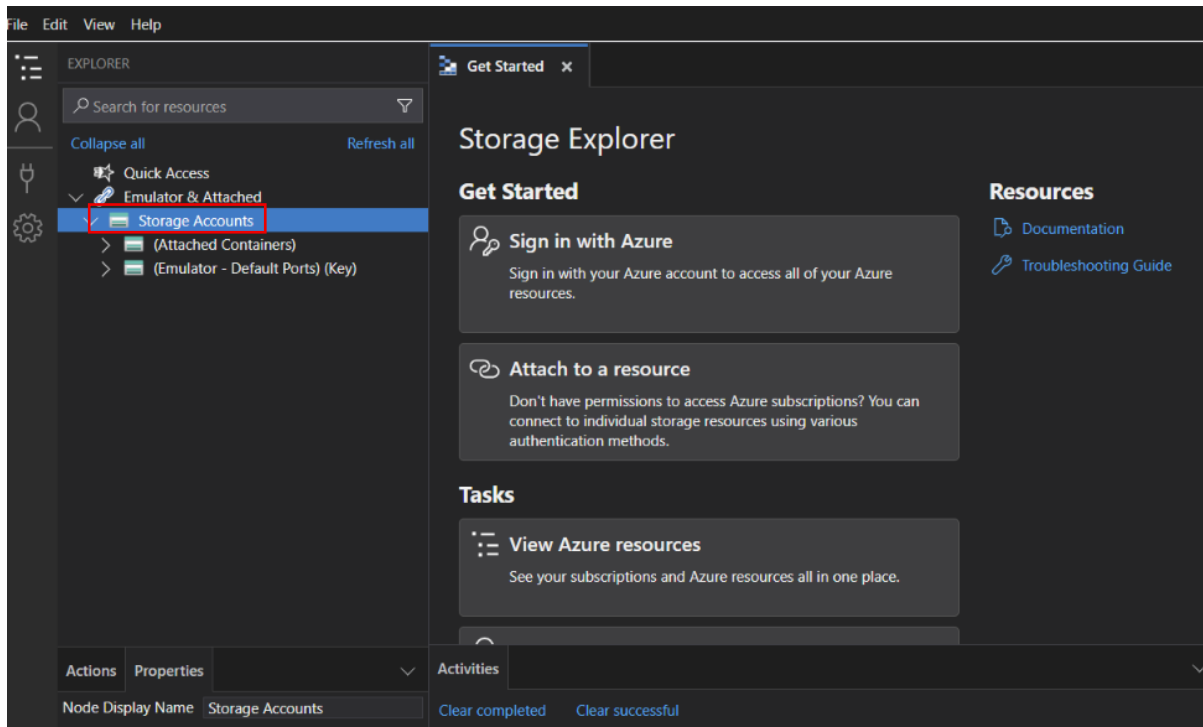


Step 3: Install Azure Storage Explorer

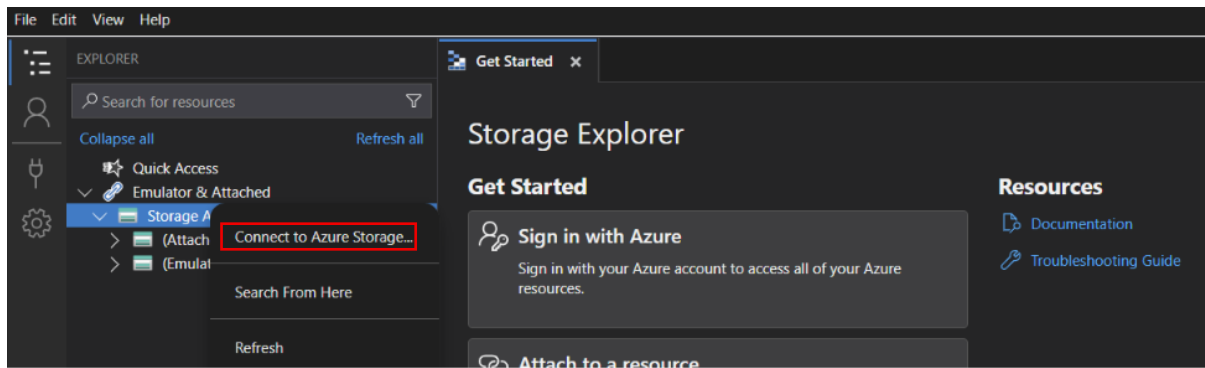
- Download and **install Azure Storage Explorer**.
- Launch the application.
- Wait for the application to load.

Step 4: Add a Storage Account

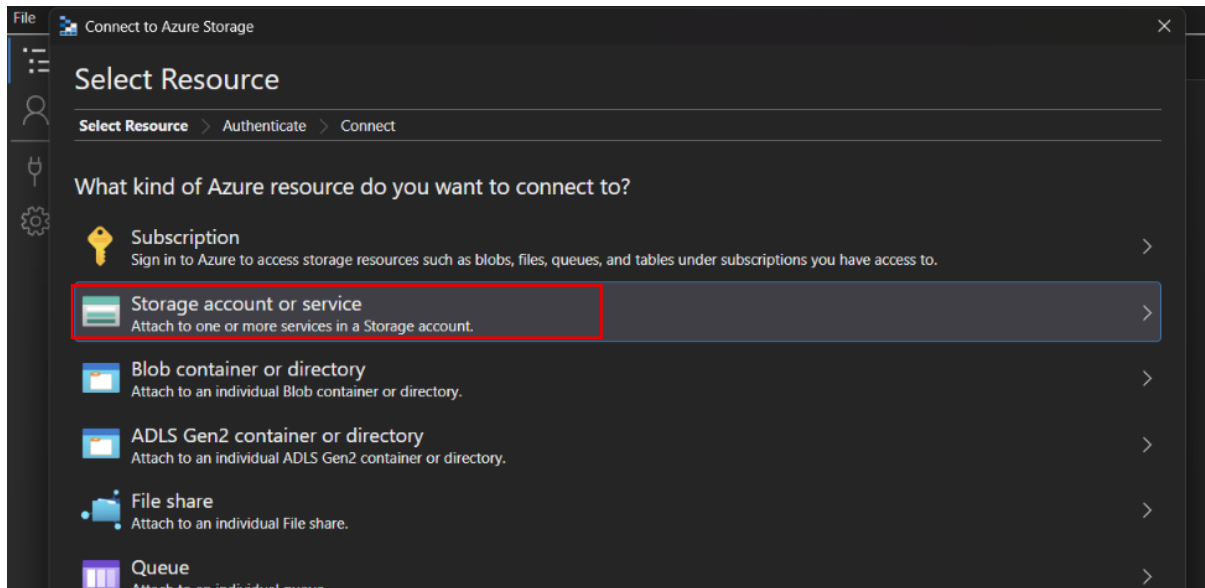
- **(Right click)** on Storage Account.



- Click **Connect**.



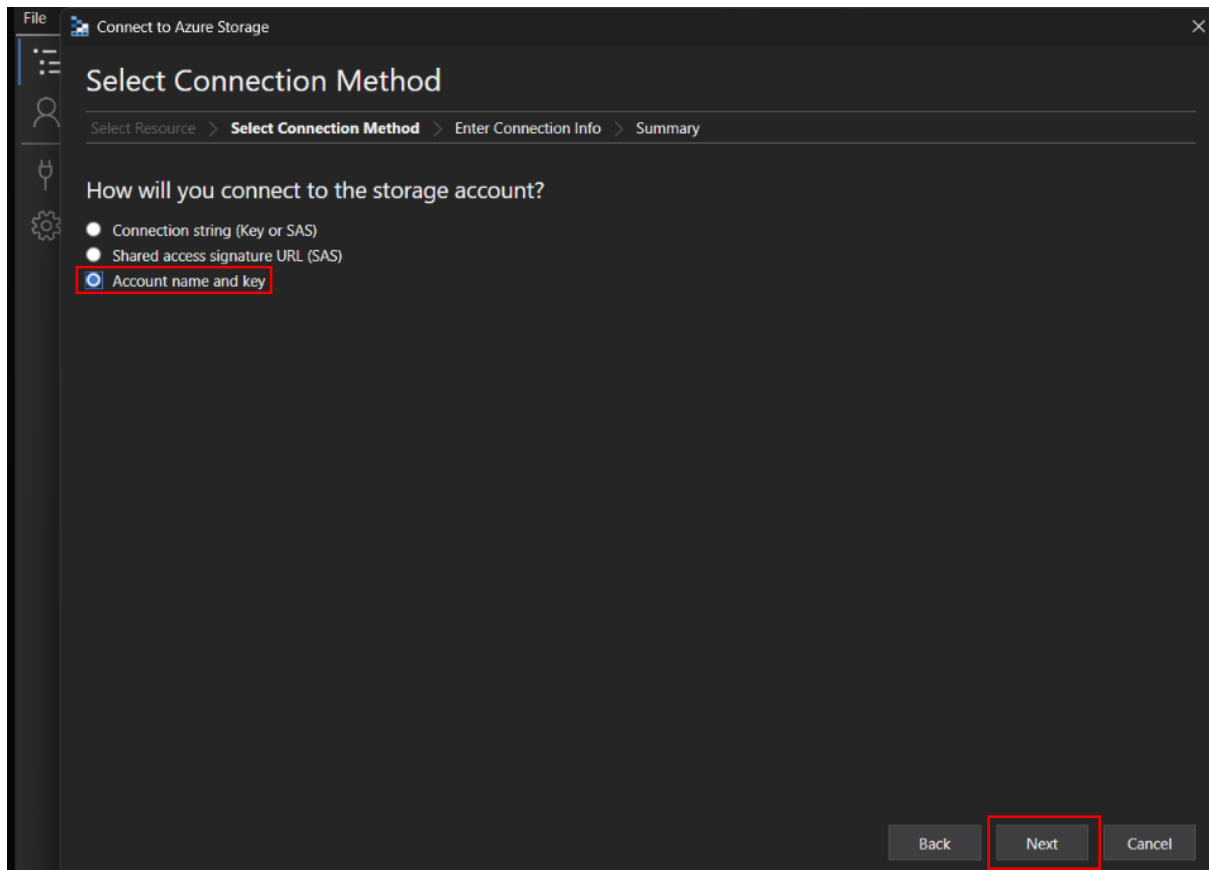
- **Select Storage account or service.**



- **Click Next.**

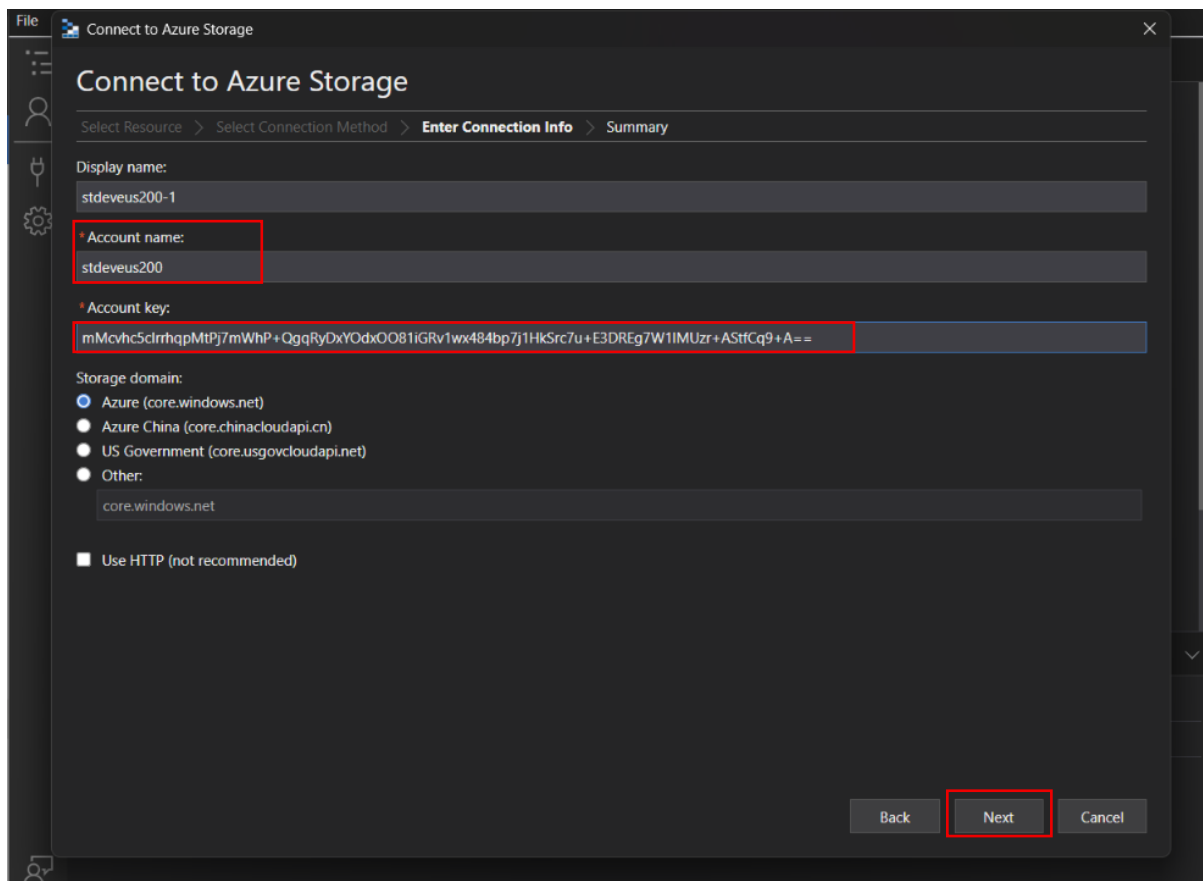
Step 5: Choose Access Key Authentication

- **Select Storage account name and key.**
- **Click Next.**



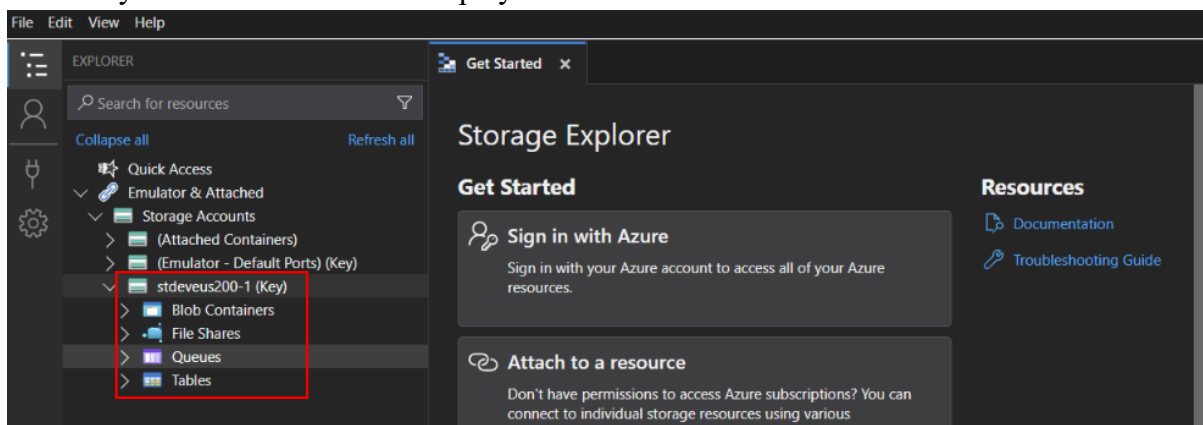
Step 6: Enter Storage Account Details

- Enter the **Storage Account Name**.
- Paste the **Access Key**.
- Give the connection a display name (optional).
- Click **Next**.
- Review the details.
- Click **Connect**.



Step 7: Verify the Connection

- Expand the connected Storage Account.
- Browse the available services:
 - Blob Containers
 - File Shares
 - Queues
 - Tables
- Verify that the resources are displayed.



Step 9: Verify the Uploaded File

- Click on the **Blob Container**.
- Navigate to **Data**.
- Confirm that the uploaded blob appears in the list.

EXPLORES

Search for resources

Collapse all

Refresh all

Quick Access

Emulator & Attached

Storage Accounts

(Attached Containers)

(Emulator - Default Ports) (Key)

stdevius200-1 (Key)

Blob Containers

\$logs

data

View all

File Shares

Queues

Tables

data

Get Started

Upload

Download

Open

Preview

New Directory

Select All

Copy

Paste

More

Active blobs (default)

data

Name	Access Tier	Access Tier Last Mod
data.txt	Hot (inferred)	